

£400

£400

A flight to Estonia.

To represent Oxford at the International Anatomy Olympiad.

Three of the four people on this team have a story like that.

I applied to my college.
I was turned down.

I went anyway.

I paid for it myself.

It was never about the money.

It was about who I was allowed to ask.

9,000 alumni

one Oxford college

200

its development office deliberately targets

8,800 people would have given me £10. There was no way on earth to reach them.



See exactly where your money goes.

The giving platform for the 8,800.

Students ask. Alumni fund. Everyone sees the receipts.

THE PROBLEM

Three people are stuck in the same gap.

Not one problem. One missing piece of infrastructure, failing three groups at once.

1 STUDENTS

Can't ask.

73%

of grant applications rejected
or under-funded

14 / 23

too embarrassed to ask publicly

*"Missed the bursary deadline.
Paid for Glasgow myself."*

Third-year, Oxford

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2 YOUNG ALUMNI

Aren't asked.

4 in 10

doubt their donation ever
reached the cause

–£1.4bn

fall in UK giving in one year

*"I actively avoid asking
anyone in their twenties."*

Development Director, Oxford college

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3 COLLEGES

Can't afford to.

£2,000

below this, an appeal costs
more than it raises

£30–50k

telethon cost, for £10–15k net

*"The problem raising money
for societies is the students."*

Head of Development, Oxford college

Every gift under £2,000 is orphaned.

Too small for a development office. Too ordinary for GoFundMe. Nobody owns this money.

£5 — £2,000

NOBODY FUNDRAISES HERE

£10,000 +

WHERE 100% OF EFFORT GOES

£150–£500

the most common amount a student
actually needs

2–3×

how often they need it,
every single year

£0

what a college can profitably
spend chasing it

Imagine if this was solved.

A student asks in ninety seconds. An alumnus gives ten pounds in twenty.

And both of them can see, afterwards, exactly what it bought.

Three steps. Ninety seconds. Zero paperwork.

1

A student asks

Verified with a university email and student card. Names the exact item, the exact cost, the exact date. Reviewed by a human before it goes live.

Free, forever

2

Alumni fund it

Shared as a link into the group chats, WhatsApp groups and society mailing lists that alumni are already in. £10 in twenty seconds. No account needed.

£10-£50 gifts

3

Everyone sees proof

Purchase evidence, photos and a closure statement are posted back to every donor. Under-spend is refunded. The community stays followed after the campaign ends.

Proof, not promises

Money never touches Dono. Every donation is a direct Stripe charge into the campaign's own account — so we hold no funds, and cannot delay, divert or lose a student's money.

LIVE PRODUCT

This is built. It is live. Here it is.

[screenshot]

Ask

Campaign created in 4 taps

[screenshot]

Discover

Browse by college & society

[screenshot]

Give

£10 in 20 seconds, guest checkout

[screenshot]

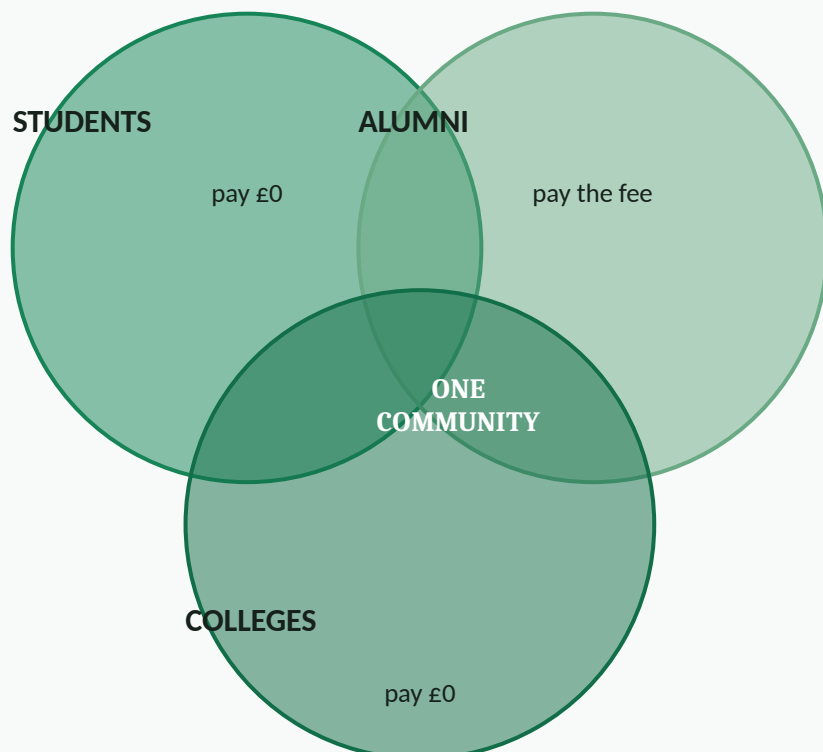
Prove

Receipts, photos, closure statement

Tested with real users. Most-praised features: the itemised cost breakdown, the receipt-style campaign card, and being able to see the fee before you pay.

Replace the four placeholders with real screenshots before pitching. Storyboard and click-by-click script: see the companion pitch script.

We do not compete with colleges. We feed them.



“Get young alumni onto the ladder who wouldn't otherwise give.”

Director of Development, 10,000-alumni Oxford college — describing our business, unprompted



Different gift size

They chase £10,000+. We handle £5–£2,000. Zero overlap.



Different donor

They deliberately don't ask under-30s. That's our entire user base.



Different cause

They fund buildings and fellowships. We fund a lab coat and a coach to Glasgow.



We hand them the pipeline

Every first-time £10 giver we create is a future major donor — with the giving habit already formed.

WHY NOBODY HAS THIS

Everyone solves one column. We solve all six.

	Built for £10–£50 gifts	Item-level receipts	Free to the institution	Community outlives campaign	Student can start in minutes	Discovery across all institutions
Dono	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
College development office	✗	~	✓	✓	✗	✗
GoFundMe / JustGiving	✓	✗	✓	✗	✓	✗
Hubbub / OxReach	~	~	✗	✗	✗	✗
Instagram + bank transfer	✓	✗	✓	✗	~	✗

Oxford already tried this. OxReach, built with a consultancy, listed six projects ever — four of them from professors. It wasn't renewed. It was built for the institution, not for students.

The old way of finding small donors is dying.

Four things had to break at once. They just did.

01 The telethon is collapsing

£30–50k cost for £10–15k net. Colleges are shutting them down. Scam awareness and AI voice-cloning are finishing the job. This was the only channel that acquired small donors.

02 Email no longer lands

Auto-filtered to promotions, open rates falling. Every development office we spoke to said the same.

03 Trust now requires proof

Four in ten Britons doubt their money arrives. Giving fell £1.4bn in a year. Transparency has become the product, not a feature.

04 £5 gifts finally work

Stripe Connect and mobile wallets made micro-donations economic. A college cannot administer a £15 restricted gift. We can, at zero marginal cost.

We didn't guess. We asked the whole market.

11

Oxford college development
offices interviewed

60k+

alumni represented by
those institutions

23

students surveyed, with
follow-up interviews

1

live campaign running now
(India Society, Ram-Leela)



Product is built and live

Not a mockup. Stripe Connect payments, human campaign review, society verification and an admin moderation portal are all shipped.



A college is waiting on us

One college told us plainly they'll join once they can see it working somewhere else. Colleges copy colleges — the first one is the only hard one.



Institutional groundwork done

Nine legal and policy documents drafted, business banking live, and the payments architecture reviewed against FCA scope before writing a line of checkout code.

WHAT THEY TOLD US

"Hubbub is expensive. Dono is free for colleges."

Oxford college, pitch meeting

"Small donors become big donors."

Development office, 9,100-alumni college

"Small donations function as test gifts."

Head of Donor Relations, Oxford college

"My college officially endorsing it."

Top trust factor — 12 of 23 students

The donor covers the fee. Everyone else pays nothing.

A £10 DONATION

Donation to campaign	£10.00
----------------------	--------

Payment processing	at cost
--------------------	---------

Dono fee (3.5%)	£0.35
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Student receives	£10.00
------------------	--------

Donor pays £10.35. Student gets the full £10.

Why the donor pays

Already the norm here: two Oxford colleges run donor-covers-the-fee checkouts today, one saving £3,000 a year. Students told us a platform skimming their money would put them off — so we don't.

Routes to market differ by side

Students: society committees and word of mouth — it's already how they organise. Alumni: the campaign link itself, forwarded into groups they're already in. Colleges: one demo case, then peer imitation.

Where this compounds

The fee is the floor, not the ceiling. What accrues is the only cross-institution graph of verified young donors in UK higher education — and every college is legally siloed from building it.

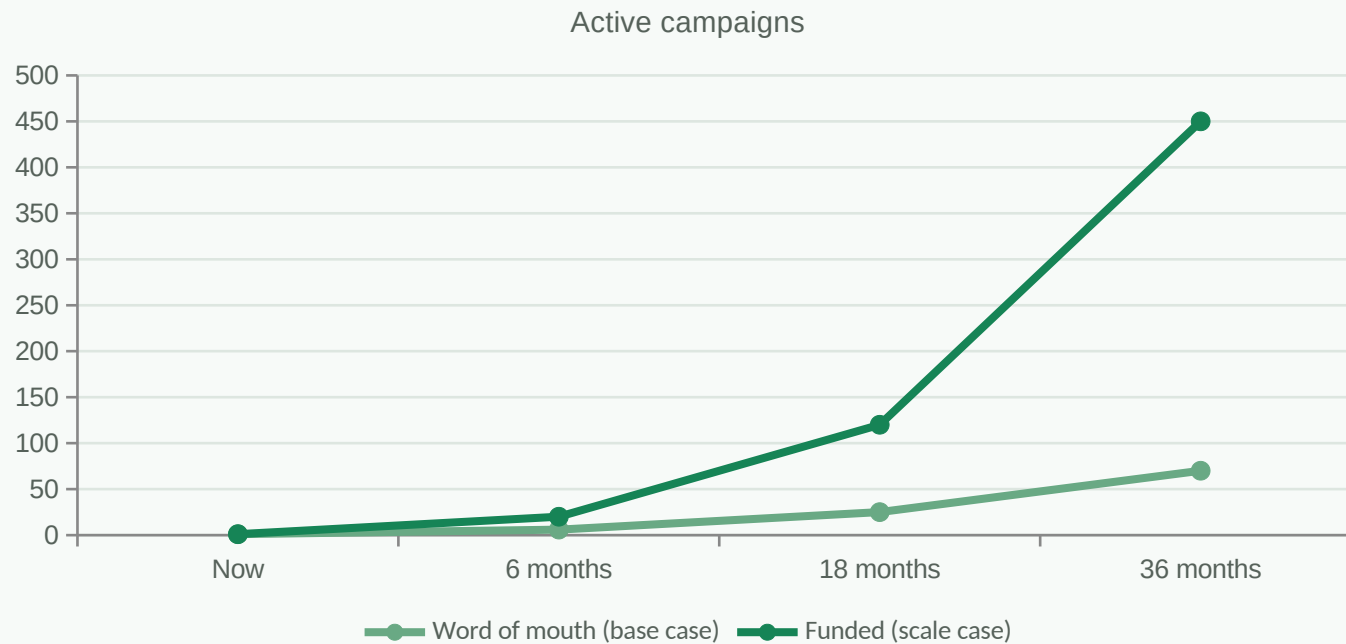
Students pay £0

Colleges pay £0

Donors pay 3.5%

We hold £0

We grow either way. Funding decides how fast.

**0-6 months**

OXFORD

Own one college

Prove the loop end to end in a single college: 20 campaigns, first repeat donors, first closure statements published.

6-18 months

OXBRIDGE

Cross the collegiate system

Colleges copy colleges. Target 8-10 Oxford colleges, then Cambridge — the same structure, the same alumni behaviour, no re-engineering.

18-36 months

UK + US

Leave the moat

UK Russell Group, then the US — where alumni giving is a cultural norm and the fraternity system is a ready-made community layer.

160 UK universities. 39 Oxford colleges alone.

Same product, no localisation, no new build.

What we'd do with it.

We have raised nothing to date. This would be the first money into Dono.

£

to reach [milestone]
in [n] months

What it buys you

The first proof that a generation written off by every development office in the country will give — repeatedly.

Acquisition

£ __

The only line that bends the curve: paid student-channel marketing, campus ambassadors, and society launch support.

Build-out

£ __

Recurring donations, refund tooling, evidence and closure workflow, society committee management.

Legal & incorporation

£ __

Solicitor sign-off on the drafted terms suite, incorporation, IP assignment, trademark filing.

Runway to the milestone

£ __

Enough months to prove repeat giving, not just first gifts — the metric that decides whether this is a business.

THE TEAM

Four people who have each paid for this problem.

We are not researching this market. We are it.

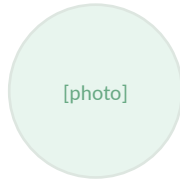


Sashank

Medicine

The customer

Ran a society, paid £400 out of pocket to represent Oxford abroad. Built the 11-college research programme.

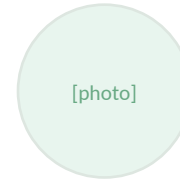


Amrit

Accountable lead

Trust & governance

Owns online safety, data protection and financial crime. Wrote the nine-document policy suite this platform runs on.

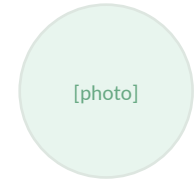


Joe

Engineering

Ships it

Commercial software engineering (Matrix42). Owns the payments architecture and the systems thinking behind it.



Juyeon

Product & design

Student distribution

Built Oxformals — a student-facing product with real Oxford users. Knows how a thing spreads on this campus.

We built the product, the payments model and the legal framework before asking anyone for a pound. *That is the whole answer to “will they actually do it?”*

Somebody paid for you.

A scholarship, a bursary, a building, a fund with someone's name on it.
You almost certainly never found out who, or what it bought.

Back the first generation that gets to find out.

